



POWER & CORRIDORS × NERAI · FORESIGHT DESK

# Supply-Chain Disruption Outlook

A 30–90 day outlook on the chokepoints, tariffs and corridors shaping global trade risk — and what they mean for your business.

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**For:** Power & Corridors readership — logistics, insurance, trade finance, procurement & corporate risk

# 1 • Executive Outlook

Global supply chains face a **synchronized, three-vector shock** over the next 30–90 days. None is, on its own, catastrophic — but together they raise freight costs, lengthen lead times and concentrate risk on a handful of corridors and product groups.

- **Strait of Hormuz** — Gulf shipping remains severely throttled despite first-round US–Iran talks; the energy and freight risk has not cleared.
- **Tariffs (US–China)** — A 30% tariff regime is holding under a 60-day pause; light-manufacturing imports sit at elevated disruption risk into the holiday season.
- **Paper, pulp & allied goods** — Layered trade-remedy actions and rerouting put these imports at the highest near-term disruption probability in the set.
- **Freight & insurance** — Any combination of the above feeds directly into container rates, war-risk premiums and inventory planning.

**Bottom line:** plan for elevated-but-manageable disruption as the base case, with a credible (~1-in-4) escalation path that would push container freight up 40–60% and squeeze holiday inventories. The window to act — re-route, pre-book, hedge, secure alternate sourcing — is now.

## 2 • Key Facts

| Vector                             | Current reading                                            | What's driving it                                                                                                                       |
|------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Strait of Hormuz</b>            | ~94% below normal transit (~5 vessels/day vs ~92 baseline) | Iran tensions; first-round US–Iran talks in Switzerland reportedly suspended after countervailing threats                               |
| <b>US–China tariffs</b>            | 30% tariffs in force under an 11 June 60-day pause         | Small/midsize importers cancelling China orders; industry bodies warning of holiday shortages                                           |
| <b>Paper &amp; pulp</b>            | ~70% next-month disruption probability                     | US antidumping injury determinations (paper bags, 2026); a Brazil/Norway dissolving-pulp case reported in final phase; tariff rerouting |
| <b>China / Hong Kong light mfg</b> | 50–59% disruption probability                              | Tariff-driven order cancellations and rerouting in toys, leather and consumer goods                                                     |
| <b>Copper (Chile)</b>              | Linked secondary signal                                    | Tracks the broader trade-friction theme; lower confidence than the lead vectors                                                         |

Readings are NERA1 live signals as of mid-June 2026; chokepoint transit from maritime tracking data. Figures are directional and refreshed continuously on the Foresight Desk.

## 3 • 30–90 Day Outlook

Three scenarios, with probabilities as analyst estimates rather than precise forecasts:

### Most likely — sustained strain, no breakout

~55%

Hormuz remains partially constrained, the US–China tariff pause holds, and paper/pulp disruption starts feeding into prices and lead times.

**What it means:** freight remains elevated and lead times lengthen, but disruption stays manageable.

**What to watch:** Hormuz daily transits, tariff-extension signals, paper/pulp rulings.

**Business action:** keep alternative routing and supplier buffers active through Q3.

### Escalation — high-impact disruption

~25%

Hormuz re-closes or becomes commercially unusable, US–China tariffs escalate after the 60-day window, and paper/pulp capacity tightens further.

**What it means:** container freight could rise sharply, Q4 inventories come under pressure, and insurance / war-risk costs increase.

**What to watch:** Hormuz below 10/day, a new military incident, China tariff reimposition, freight +20% week-on-week.

**Business action:** activate contingency routing, pre-book capacity, and review force-majeure and insurance clauses.

### Improvement — de-escalation path

~20%

US–Iran talks resume, Hormuz traffic improves, and the US–China tariff pause is extended or converted into a more durable arrangement.

**What it means:** freight and energy pressure ease, but normalisation remains gradual.

**What to watch:** Hormuz above 30/day, falling war-risk premiums, a tariff-extension notice, Brent stabilisation.

**Business action:** unwind contingency measures slowly; do not assume an immediate return to pre-crisis routing.

## 4 • Business Implications

**Logistics operators.** Expect continued Gulf re-routing (Cape of Good Hope), longer Asia–Europe transit and tighter capacity. Pre-book space, diversify carriers and corridors, and build buffer stock on exposed lanes.

**Insurers & brokers.** War-risk and marine premiums stay elevated on Gulf/Red Sea routing; watch accumulation and price the re-closure tail explicitly. Note that the largest losses often come from operational/technical incidents, not only headline geopolitics.

**Banks & trade finance.** Re-routing shifts counterparties and lengthens tenors on affected corridors. Stress-test exposure to paper/pulp and China light-manufacturing flows, and to clients dependent on Hormuz energy throughput.

**Procurement teams.** Paper/pulp and light manufacturing carry the highest near-term disruption risk. Secure alternate sourcing, pull forward critical orders, and treat the tariff-pause expiry as a hard planning date.

## 5 • Watch Indicators

| Indicator                                 | Threshold to watch                         | What it signals                                |
|-------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|
| Hormuz daily transits                     | Sustained >30/day → easing · <10/day       | Re-closure risk / Gulf supply shock            |
| US–Iran talks status                      | Resumption vs collapse + military rhetoric | De-escalation or escalation of the lead vector |
| US–China 60-day tariff pause              | Extension/deal vs lapse (≈ early Aug)      | Relief or tariff escalation into peak season   |
| USITC trade-remedy rulings (paper/pulp)   | Final affirmative determinations           | Confirms paper/pulp disruption                 |
| Container freight indices (SCFI / Drewry) | +20% week-on-week                          | Stress building across corridors               |
| Global supply-chain pressure (GSCPI)      | Rising above +2σ                           | Systemic, not single-corridor, pressure        |

## 6 • Strategic Forecast

The next 30–90 days are likely to be defined less by a single supply-chain shock than by the **interaction of geopolitics and geoeconomics** across several exposed corridors. The US–Iran MoU may reduce immediate escalation pressure, but it does not yet restore full commercial confidence in Hormuz or remove the wider proxy, sanctions and nuclear risks that shaped the crisis. At the same time, the US–China tariff pause **freezes rather than resolves** trade friction, leaving importers exposed to renewed policy volatility as they enter peak ordering windows.

In this environment, supply-chain risk is not only about vessel movement; it is about whether political agreements are **trusted enough by insurers, carriers, banks and procurement teams to change behaviour**. Our outlook is therefore one of **cautious strain rather than normalisation**. Energy flows may recover faster than containerised cargo, sensitive industrial shipments and longer-cycle procurement categories, while tariff-sensitive goods remain vulnerable to order delays, rerouting and inventory compression.

Businesses should assume that corridor risk, trade-policy risk and insurance risk will remain **connected through Q3 2026**. The most important signal will not be diplomatic language alone, but whether ships, insurers, financiers and buyers act as if conditions have genuinely stabilised. Until that happens, firms

should maintain alternative routing, supplier buffers and tariff-contingency planning — using any short-term easing to **strengthen resilience rather than reduce it**.

## 7 • Methodology Note

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NERAI combines **import-flow disruption modelling** (trained on US import data, 2013–present), **open-source event monitoring**, **maritime chokepoint transit data** and **analyst review**. Probabilities are calibrated model estimates, reviewed by an analyst, and should be read as directional rather than precise. The Foresight Desk refreshes the underlying signals continuously.

**Technical appendix.** Disruption model as-of 1 April 2026 · out-of-sample Brier 0.101 · calibration error (ECE) 0.026 · Precision@10% 0.637. Confidence by vector — Hormuz operational disruption: moderate-to-high (subject to transit verification); paper/pulp: high model signal / moderate source confidence; China–Hong Kong tariff disruption: moderate. This outlook is informational and not financial, legal or investment advice.